



Solution Blueprint

Price Management – Oracle Retail Pricing Cloud Service

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Change Control

DATE	VERSION	AUTHOR	REVIEW
09/03/2026	1.0	Retail Consult	Initial Version

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Requirements identified are highlighted in blue.

Decisions taken are highlighted in orange.

Assumptions taken are highlighted in green.

Open points are highlighted in yellow.

Price Management

Oracle Retail Pricing Cloud Service (RPCS) is a configurable and flexible pricing solution designed to meet the varied needs of the retail industry.

RPCS empowers retailers to streamline pricing strategies across the organization, yielding a more predictable and profitable outcome. It provides decision support through pricing-focused business information to validate and approve new retails and markdowns.

This application supports the creation and management of price changes, clearance markdowns and promotional offers, integrating with the pricing execution systems, such as e-commerce systems, to provide details on these events when approved.

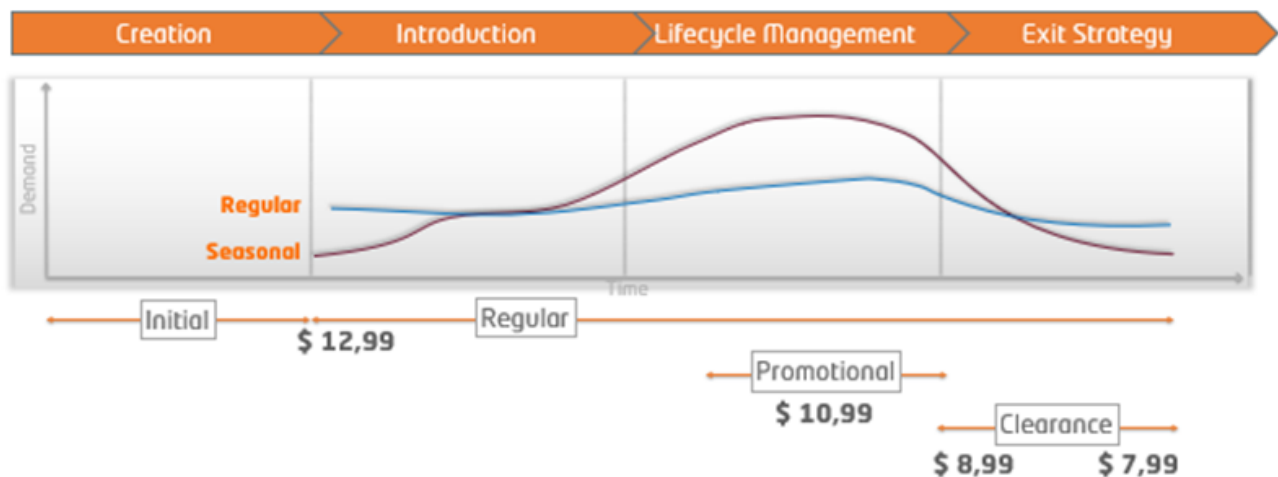


Figure 1 - Pricing lifecycle sample

Retail Pricing Cloud Service (RPCS)

Retailers leverage Oracle Retail Merchandising Cloud Services to execute core merchandising activities, including merchandise and inventory management, replenishment, purchasing, sales auditing, and pricing. As a critical part of this suite of cloud services, the Oracle Retail Pricing Cloud Service (RPCS) provides the ability to define, maintain, and review price changes, clearances, and promotions, as well as provides the ability to execute the price events by passing approved price events onto downstream selling systems for execution.

In Retail Pricing Cloud Service, you can define:

1. Foundation Data:
 - a. Define Zones Structures.
 - b. Rounding Rules.
 - c. Define Initial Selling price.
 - d. Conflict Check Rules
2. Price Events:
 - a. Regular Price Changes.
 - b. Clearance Markdown.
 - c. Promotions.
3. Reporting:
 - a. Price Inquiry.
 - b. Pricing Analyst.
 - c. Promotions Planner.

Pricing Zone Structure

The Pricing Zone Structure allows to define groupings of locations (stores or warehouses) for pricing purposes and eliminates the need to manage pricing at a more granular location level. The function of this structure is to group locations together in a manner that best facilitates company pricing strategies (based on geographic regions or store characteristics, for example).

At the highest level, these groupings are divided into categories called Zone Groups, and within each zone group, there are Zones, which are groups of locations (stores or warehouses). Best practice is to create a zone group for initial pricing purposes, including all Stores in the company.

There are no restrictions on the number of locations a zone can contain, and a location can (and likely will) exist in multiple zone groups. However, RPCS has two rules to take into consideration when creating the relationship between locations and zones:

1. A location cannot exist in more than one zone within a zone group.
2. All locations within the same zone must use the same currency.

After the initial pricing zone structure is defined, it can be changed; however, the following should be considered:

1. Locations can be moved between zones inside a zone group.
2. Locations can be added to a zone inside a zone group.
3. Locations can be removed from a zone inside a zone group.
4. When a location is added to an existing zone:
 - It will participate in any price events that are approved in the future.
 - It will not inherit any existing approved events.
5. When a location is removed from a zone:
 - It will stay on any existing approved events.
 - It will not be included in any new events created for that zone.

Additionally, please note that if a store needs to be added to or removed from an ongoing event, setting this event back to the worksheet and re-approving it will adjust the event for that given store.

Example 1: Pricing zone structure for initial selling price definitions (when new items are created in MFCS). We suggest Claire’s use this structure for the initial selling price and day-by-day activities.

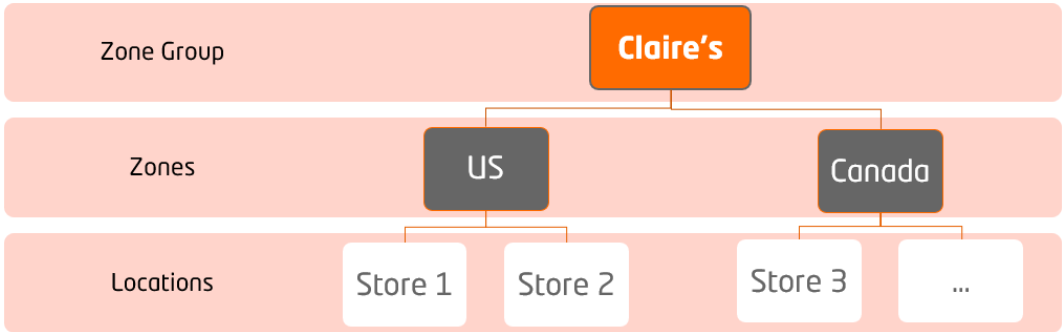


Figure 2 - Example of Initial Pricing zone structure

Example 2: Pricing zone structure for day-to-day selling price management.

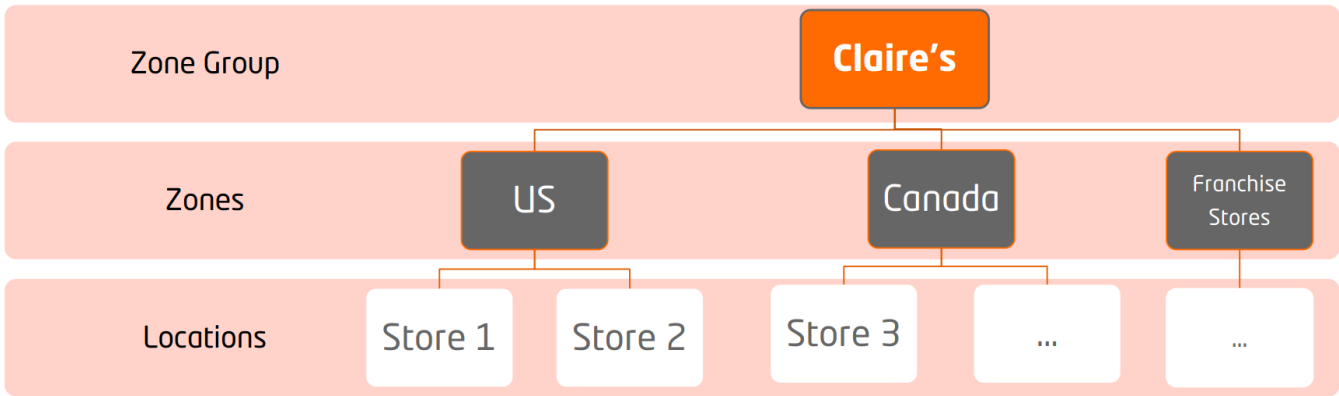


Figure 3 - Example of Daily selling price zone structure

O.RPCS.01: Claire’s need to define the Zone Structure to be configured in RPCS.

Rounding Rules

Rounding rules are optional but can help users create a uniform pricing strategy. They are used to “smooth” proposed selling prices to maintain a consistent set of price points by applying “ends in” logic.

Rounding rules are defined globally but can include exceptions/exclusions based on merchandise hierarchy or currency, and can optionally be applied to the following price event types:

- Initial selling price
- Regular selling price changes
- Clearance markdowns

When creating Rounding Rules in RPCS, it is possible to define default rounding rules to be applied to regular selling price changes or clearance markdowns, which will be pre-selected when price events of these types are created.

A.22 – Claire’s not use automatic rounding on their prices.

Merchandise Hierarchy Zone Groups - Initial Selling Price

The Merchandise Hierarchy Zone Groups are a mandatory configuration needed for RPCS to be able to suggest an initial selling price of the new items created in MFCS (a sellable item must be created already with a regular selling price).

- Please note that initial selling price suggestions can be adjusted manually at the zone level in MFCS before completing this part of the item creation process.

To suggest this initial price, RPCS has available Cost or Retail markup calculations that use the markup percentage defined by the user during the Merchandise Hierarchy Zone Groups setup:

- Cost-based calculation: $Selling\ Price = (Cost \times (1 + Markup\ \%)) \times (1 + VAT)$
- Retail-based calculation: $Selling\ Price = \left(\frac{Cost}{1 - Markup\ \%} \right) \times (1 + VAT)$

These markup calculation types and respective markup percentages are defined at the merchandise hierarchy department level or below, each linked to a price zone group for which the initial selling price is automatically defined.

In Claire’s item creation process, the initial price is already defined, based on a decision made together with the buyer, before the items are created in MFCS. Therefore, in RPCS, a default markup type and

percentage will be configured for all merchandise departments currently created and those to be created in the future in MFCS to guarantee this mandatory configuration.

The following steps are the high-level process used by MFCS to suggest initial selling prices when a new item is created:

- 1. Lookup the lowest level of the item’s merchandise hierarchy that is setup in RPCS initial price zone setup, collecting:
 - a. Markup type
 - b. Markup percentage
 - c. Zone group defined as primary.
 - d. Rounding rules (optional)
- 2. Lookup unit cost of the item for the primary supplier/country of sourcing.
- 3. Suggest zone level pricing based on the information gathered in steps 1 and 2.

Example:

Department	61 - Rings
Primary Zone Group	1 - Claire's
Markup Type	Cost
Markup Percentage	10%
Rounding Rules	Ends in .99
Cost (Primary Supplier / Country of Sourcing)	10
Initial Price before applying Rounding rules	\$11
Final Suggested Initial Price	\$11.99

Figure 4 - Example of Initial selling price

D.46: Retail prices are manually defined for each item based on cost and customer's value perception, so a default markup will be defined for all departments only to comply with the mandatory PCS configuration of Merchandise Hierarchy Zone Groups.

A.23: When creating items, it will be necessary to define the prices for each price zone manually. For price zone related with the Franchise Stores, the price will be defined after the item creation in RPCS.

Conflict Check Rules

The Conflict Check Rules are automatic validations executed by RPCS to ensure the integrity of data when regular price changes and clearances are approved, unapproved, and optionally, when submitted.

To improve the overall process of defining and maintaining the conflict rules, a spreadsheet upload process is present within Merchandising (Template type = Price and Cost, Template = Price Event Conflict Rules) that enables the user to view the entire set of rules that are present.

It is not possible to add new conflict check rules to RPCS; however, the following list covers all the validations needed to maintain a healthy price management:

- Multiple UOMs for Fixed Price Change
- Duplicate Price Change
- Duplicate Clearance
- Duplicate Clearance Reset
- Approved Clearance Reset not allowed with Approved Markdown
- Price Change (for single or multi-unit) allowed Only After Clearance Reset
- Future Retail cannot be Negative (regular price and clearance price)
- A Clearance Reset cannot be approved for an item/loc that is not actively on clearance
- Clearance retail must be less than or equal to single unit regular retail***
- Clearance retail must be less than the previous markdown***
- Regular Retail must be greater than or equal to the Pricing Cost***
- Clearance Retail must be greater than or equal to the Pricing Cost***

***** Rule with Enable or Disable option**

Regular Selling Price Changes

A regular price change is a permanent change to the regular selling price of an item, and inventory is consequently revalued when it goes into effect – these can be created as a reaction to competitor pricing, supplier cost changes, or to achieve target profit margins.

There are multiple ways in which regular price changes can be created:

1. Using the UI based process available in RPCS.
2. Using a Quick Create process, which is simpler and more streamlined for quick, regular price change creation.
3. Through a spreadsheet-based upload process, using a pre-defined template.

When a regular price change is created, the following information needs to be specified:

- **Items:** items receiving the price change, by selecting items by parent, parent/diff, item list, upload list, or transaction items directly.
- **Locations:** where the price change is occurring, by selecting zones, location lists, or stores directly.
- **Regular Price:** how the price is changing, by selecting a percent or amount change, or a new fixed price.
- **Effective Date:** when the price change will take effect, by defining an effective date.
- **Reason:** why the price change is occurring, by optionally specifying a reason code.

When creating price changes for a group of items and locations, it is recommended to do so at the highest level possible. For instance, instead of creating price changes at the location level, create them at the zone level when possible/applicable. It is also recommended that Price Change Groups be used (groupings of multiple price changes), as this allows for mass maintenance (i.e., approval).

It is also possible to create **Emergency Price Change**, which are those that must be effective in fewer days than the minimum number of days defined in RPCS. This allows retailers to send these prices to downstream systems immediately, and it is controlled by a special security permission that users must be assigned to be able to create emergency price changes.

Due to Claire's business model, regular item prices are defined by the buyer and typically remain unchanged until the item enters clearance. Therefore, RPCS regular price changes will be used only occasionally, mainly to correct incorrectly defined regular prices.

D.79: Prices for the franchise stores will be created in Pricing after the item creation/approval.

Multi-Unit Prices

RPCS also supports the concept of Multi-Unit Pricing, so that multiples of a given transactional item can be sold at a different regular selling price than the sum of the individual item's regular selling price.

This multi-unit pricing can be applied in scenarios where these packs are not defined in the merchandising system.

Note: Claire's doesn't have items for which it is possible to apply Multi-Unit Price.



Hypothetical example – We have a four earrings pack that the customer can choose to tear open a single unit from the pack or buy the entire pack.

- An individual Earring can be sold at \$2.00.
- A four-pack of the same earring is sold at \$7 (or \$1,75 per individual earring).

Price Change Lifecycle

The following diagram depicts the lifecycle of regular price changes:

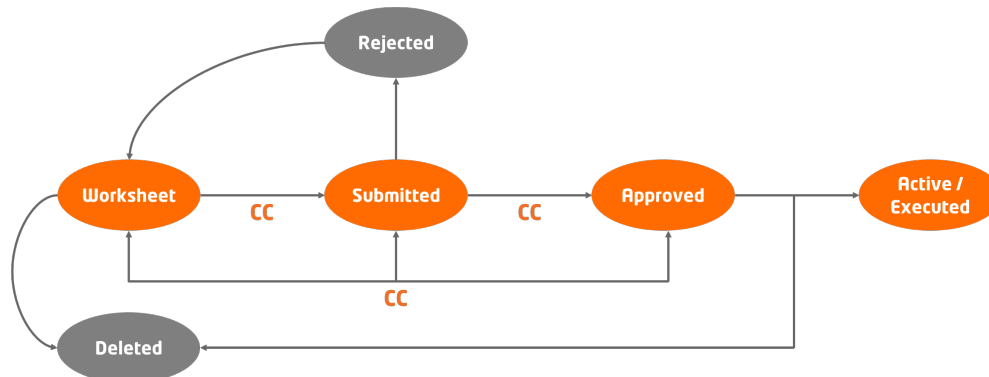


Figure 5 - Example of definition of Rounding Rules

This process includes a feature called Conflict Checking (CC) – this is a background process that checks the integrity and correctness of a price event, based on a specific set of rules, when submitted (based on system option) or approved.

A.24: Regular item prices typically remain unchanged until items enter clearance; therefore, Claire's will use regular price changes only occasionally.

A.25: Claire's does not use multi-unit pricing, but RPCS will have this functionality available in case it is needed in the future.

Clearance Markdowns

A clearance markdown is considered a permanent change to the selling price of an item, and inventory is consequently revalued when it goes into effect. Clearance markdowns are typically designed to clear out-of-date or slow-selling merchandise out of stores and warehouses.

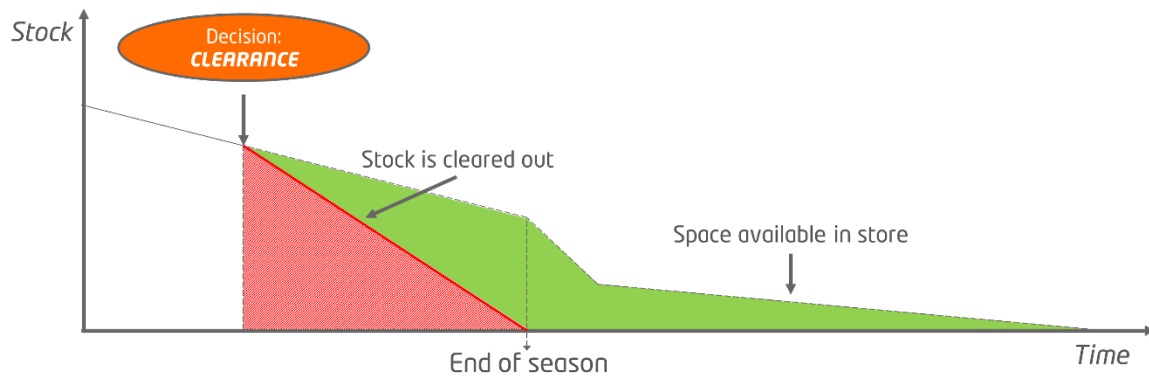


Figure 6 - Sample effect of a clearance markdown in stock levels over time

There are multiple ways in which clearance markdowns can be created, like those available for creating regular price changes:

1. Using the UI based process available in RPCS.
2. Using a Quick Create process, which is simpler and more streamlined for quick clearance markdown creation.
3. Through a spreadsheet-based upload process, using a pre-defined template.

It is recommended to group multiple clearance markdowns by using the RPCS Clearance Groups, which allows mass maintenance, for example, mass approval or cancellation.

When creating a clearance markdown in RPCS, the following information needs to be specified:

- **Items:** items receiving the clearance markdown, by selecting items by parent, parent/diff, item list, upload list, or transaction items directly.
- **Locations:** where the clearance markdown is occurring, by selecting zones, location lists or Stores directly.
- **Clearance Price:** the decrease in selling price, by selecting a percent or amount change, or a new fixed price.
- **Effective Date:** when the clearance markdown will take effect, by defining an effective date.
- **Reason:** why the clearance markdown occurs, by optionally specifying a reason code.

When creating clearance markdowns for a group of items and stores, it is recommended to do so at the highest level possible. For instance, instead of creating clearance markdowns at the store level, create them

at the zone level when possible/applicable. After the clearance markdown becomes active, it is possible to manually create additional, deeper markdowns for items/locations to further support the clearance strategy.

The Claire's clearance markdowns are normally created at the Style Item Level, which will help with a better understanding and management of what items should be in clearance.

Emergency Clearance Markdowns, as emergency price changes, can also be created to be effective in fewer days than the minimum number of days defined in RPCS. This allows retailers to send these prices to downstream systems immediately, and is controlled by a special security permission that users must be assigned to be able to create emergency clearance markdowns

To end a clearance markdown and, with that, change the item price from clearance price to regular price, there are two options available:

1. Create a clearance reset for a specific effective date, or
 - a. On the reset date, the selling price is reverted to the last regular selling price.
 - b. It is only possible to create a clearance reset to active clearance markdowns.
2. Create a price change for a specific effective date;
 - a. On the price change date, the clearance markdown is replaced by the new regular selling price.

A.26: The clearance price of Canada should be defined manually based on the US price.

D.47: The Clearance Markdowns are created at the Style/SKU Item Level.

Clearance Lifecycle

The following diagram depicts the lifecycle of clearance markdowns:

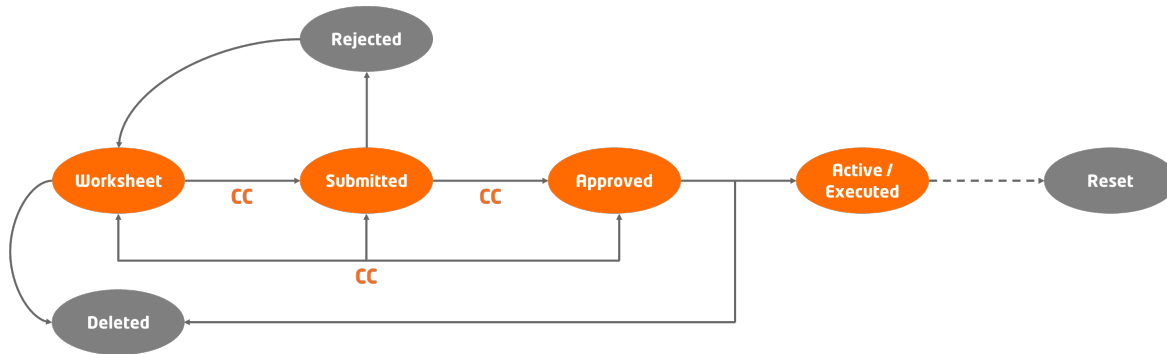


Figure 7 - Clearance markdown lifecycle

This process includes a feature called Conflict Checking (CC), like that of regular price changes – this is a background process that checks the integrity and correctness of a price event, based on a specific set of rules, when submitted (based on system option) or approved.

Clearance Cadence Templates

The Clearance Cadence Templates functionality allows users to quickly apply a predefined series of markdowns when creating clearance markdowns.

By selecting a template, the clearance markdown is automatically configured with the predefined markdown steps based on the initial effective date. Each template includes a configurable number of steps, where each step defines the number of days between markdowns and the discount percentage to apply.

Promotions and Offers

Promotional price changes are temporary reductions in price for one or more items at one or more stores for a defined amount of time.

These types of prices are managed using a three-level structure:

- **Campaigns:** Optional attribute that can be used to link promotions, for instance, for reporting purposes (i.e., Christmas campaign).
- **Promotions:** A collection of one or more offers.
- **Offers:** Definition of items/stores, the reward, and conditions to receive it, as well as start/end dates.

There are a few additional concepts that are relevant regarding promotional offers, which are presented in the following bullet points:

- **Apply Discount Up To:** Optional attribute that it is possible to define the number of times that the discount can be applied to a customer's purchase.
- **Coupon Code:** Can be used to indicate that a specific coupon is required to have the discount applied to their purchase (i.e., employee or referral discounts). To RPCS, this is only an extra optional attribute, so any coupon management should be done in an external system.
- **Price Restriction:** Can be used as additional offer condition criteria; for instance, to exclude items that fall outside of a defined price range.
- **Apply To:** Indicate what item price the Offers can be applied to (regular price, clearance items, or both). Can be limited using a system option.
- **Customer Description:** This Customer Description can be used for printing a specific Promotion Description on a receipt or on the website.
- **Exclusive Discount:** An optional attribute that indicates if a given offer is exclusive of other discounts.

There are multiple ways in which promotional offers can be created:

1. Using the UI based process available in RPCS.
2. Using a "Create from Existing" feature that copies the details of an existing offer, allowing for editing of its' details to create a new offer.
3. Through a spreadsheet-based upload process, using a pre-defined template.

Both Offer creation using options 2 and 3 described above can be used to implement cyclical intraday promotions, either by copying one instance multiple times for different dates, or by doing a bulk upload via a spreadsheet template to create multiple instances of an offer.

RPCS also supports the definition of items that should be excluded from promotional offers – it allows for excluding specific items from offers, when defining what items are subject to an offer at a higher level

than that of transactional level items (i.e., if an offer is defined for whole branches of the merchandise hierarchy).

Emergency Offers can also be created to be effective in less days than the minimum number of days defined in RPCS. This allows retailers to send these prices to downstream systems immediately and is controlled by a special security permission that users must be assigned to be able to create emergency offers.

The Offer promotions are divided into two levels of offers: Item and Transaction. Each of these levels contains multiple offer types, for which there are several offer templates available to be used. The offer templates are the promotional mechanism that can be created in RPCS.

Item Level – Offers Templates Available

Offer Type	Template	Example
Simple Discount	Get Y for Discount	10% off all Key Chains
Buy/Get	Buy X, Get Discount	Buy any 3x Key Chains, get 30% off
Buy/Get	Spend X, Get Discount	Spend \$50 in T-shirts, get \$10 off
Buy/Get	Buy X, Get Y for Discount	Buy 2x Sunglasses, get 1x Cap for 50% off
Buy/Get	Spend X, Get Y for Discount	Spend \$100 on Hoodies, get 25% off any 2x T-shirts
Buy/Get	Buy X of Single Item for Discount	Buy 2x Beach Towels for \$30
Buy/Get	Buy X and Y, Get Discount	Buy 1x Sweatshirt, 1x Hoodie, and 1x T-Shirt for \$15
Buy/Get	Buy X and Y, Get Z for Discount	Buy 1x T-Shirt and 1x Shorts, get 25% off Bag
Gift with Purchase	Buy X, Get Gift with Purchase	Buy any 3x T-Shirts, get 1x Cap for free
Gift with Purchase	Spend X, Get Gift with Purchase	Spend \$60 in T-Shirts, get 1x Cap for free

Transaction Level - Offers Templates Available

Offer Type	Template	Example
Simple Discount	Get Discount	10% off your purchase today only
Buy/Get	Buy X, Get Discount	Buy 3x T-Shirts, get \$15 off your purchase
Buy/Get	Spend X, Get Discount	Spend \$100 in T-Shirts, get 5% off your purchase

Offer Lifecycle

The following diagram depicts the lifecycle of offers:

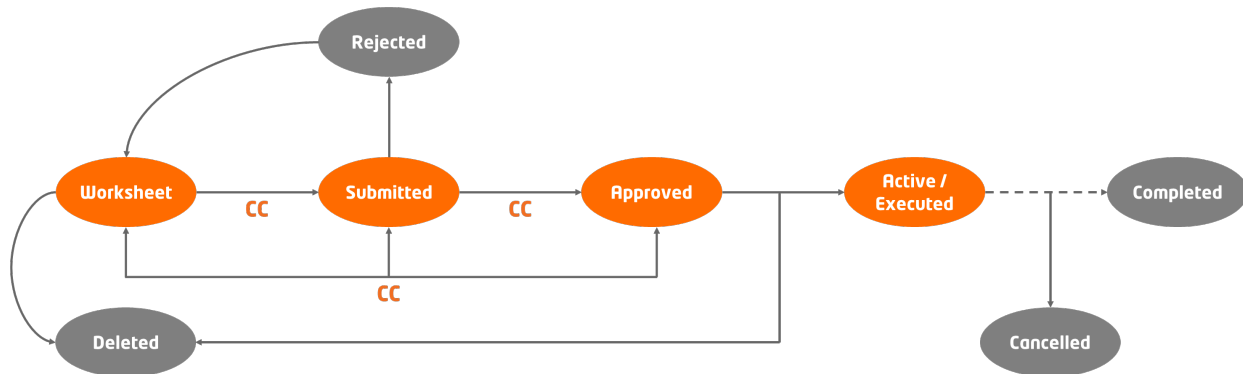


Figure 8 - Offer Lifecycle

This process includes a feature called Conflict Checking (CC), this is a background process that checks the integrity and correctness of a price event, based on a specific set of rules, when submitted (based on system option) or approved.

D.48: The promotions will be managed in Customer Engagement (ORCE).

Reports and Dashboards

RPCS has two types of reports: dashboard reports and contextual reports.

- **Dashboard reports** are role-based and are intended to highlight actionable or frequently monitored activities to help the Pricing Analyst and Promotion Planner manage exceptions in their business and prioritize their work for the day.
- **Contextual reports** are displayed in selected Pricing pages and allow for an extension of information available in the associated screen, providing further details about a transaction or entity that is not present on the screen.

In addition to dashboard and contextual reports, RPCS provides the Price Inquiry functionality, which allows users to view the price history of an item across one or more locations for a selected date in the past, present, or future.

Pricing Analytics Dashboard

This dashboard is intended to highlight to a pricing analyst pricing events that require attention. This may be because it is due to go into effect in the next few days, it is an emergency price change, or it has conflicts.

Inside this dashboard, we can find two sections:

- **Price Changes Pending Approval:** Unapproved price changes that have an effective date in the next week or over the next four weeks, based on a report-level toggle system option.
- **Clearances Pending Approval Report:** Unapproved clearance markdowns or resets that have an effective date in the next week or over the next four weeks, based on a report-level toggle system option.

Promotion Planner Dashboard

This dashboard displays to a promotion planner details about upcoming promotional offers for their area of responsibility, as determined by the dashboard filters.

The promotion planner dashboard has the following section:

- **Upcoming Offers:** Timeline view of promotional offers that will occur in the next 6 months, based on the entered filter criteria. It is intended to help the promotional planner visually see where there may be too many or too few offers in effect for a given period.

Contextual Reports

RPCS has several contextual reports, in a collapsible pane, that display additional information that can be used in the context of the workflow/functionality where the contextual reports are presented. The following list details the existing contextual reports in RPCS:

- **Item Details** - Item Details report shows additional item information that may not be available in the associated screen, such as merchandise hierarchy, supplier, cost and retail, country and pack size. For Pricing, this report does not consider location, so all details are at the item level. This report is displayed by default in multiple screens in Pricing.
- **Price Summary** - The Price Summary Report shows a summary of the current and future pricing activity for an item/location combination. The location could be a single store or warehouse, or a zone.
- **Inventory Summary** - This report displays inventory for an item or item/location, stock on hand, in transit, and on order, using a pie chart to help pricing analysts assess potential markdowns or markups during a price event. It includes toggles to view data by item or item/location and to filter by all locations, stores, or warehouses (or by zone at item/location level).
- **Conflict Details** - Displayed in the Conflicts screen, this report shows additional detail to the pricing analyst when reviewing conflicts found for a price change, clearance markdown, or clearance reset.
- **Margin Impact** - The Margin Impact report provides insight into item margin considering cost and price change events. It displays cost, retail, and margin values relative to the selected report date, and charts trends over time, using a blue line for cost changes and a red line for retail price changes, based on the configured Margin Impact Month Range.
- **Promotions** - This report will display promotions, in a tabular format, for an item/location passed to the report that are active on the dates passed to the report. This could be a single date or a range of dates, as in the Price Inquiry, where the report is displayed by default.

Appendix

FILE NAME	DESCRIPTION	TOPIC

Glossary

ACRONYM	DESCRIPTION
RPCS	Retail Pricing Cloud Service
CC	Conflict Check
MFCS	Merchandising Foundation Cloud Service
SOB	SET OF BOOKS
POS	POINT OF SERVICE
CFA	CUSTOM FLEX ATTRIBUTE
RTV	RETURN TO VENDOR
ST	STORE
WH	WAREHOUSE
DC	DISTRIBUTION CENTER
DSD	DIRECT STORE DELIVERY
EDI	ELECTRONIC DATA INTERCHANGE
ASN	ADVANCED SHIPMENT NOTICE
VAT	VALUE ADDED TAX
SKU	STOCK KEEPING UNIT
UOM	UNIT OF MEASURE
UOP	UNIT OF PURCHASE
EAN	EUROPEAN ARTICLE NUMBER